Viraj Mahesh

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EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Manager, YouTube Watch Page — Oct 2024 – Present

- Partner with a team of 50 engineers, 3 designers and 2 researchers to set the vision and strategy for the YouTube Watch Page, which drives over 90% of YouTube's engagement and 70% of revenue.
- Mentor three junior PMs, partnering with our shared manager to define scope, delegate responsibilities, and manage execution on the Watch Page product strategy.
- Present the team's roadmap to senior executives, securing buy-in on the strategy and resources for the team.
- Drove experiments with swipeable feed combining video browsing and playback. This was a complex project that touched every part of the user experience from video creation to discovery, consumption and monetization.
- Vibecode prototypes for internal demos and user research, reducing risk and speeding time to product-market fit.

Senior Product Manager, YouTube — Jan 2020 – Sep 2024

- Identified and championed the opportunity for YouTube to lead the industry in core player features, successfully securing necessary resources from YouTube leadership.
- Launched long-press to fast forward (**XXXM** DAUs), bigger image previews while seeking (**XB** DAUs), pinch-to-zoom (**XXXM** DAUs), precise seeking (**XXM** DAUs), and most replayed moments (**XXXM** DAUs).
- Launched auto-generated chapters for **XXM** videos (announced by Sundar Pichai at Google I/O). Shipped the first generative AI feature at YouTube in 2022.
- Grew the Premium business by **+5%** subscribers through tactical, low costs projects like showing the download button in more places. Influenced leadership to invest in this opportunity despite this being a "grungy" area of work outside the team's core charter.
- Launched PiP on iOS (**+5%** watchtime), Smart Downloads (**+10%** download watchtime), and downloads in the browser (**+4%** Premium signups) for YouTube Premium members, adding value to the membership, and increasing member retention.
- Convinced the organization to invest in social features after multiple failed efforts by other teams by taking a different approach and meeting users where they are rather than building a social network from scratch.
- Launched co-watch interactions with Discord, Google Meet, and Apple FaceTime.

Product Manager, YouTube Go & Android Phone App — Jul 2018 – Jan 2020

- Grew YouTube Go (app for India and Indonesia) from XXM to XXM DAUs.

Product Manager, YouTube Go & Android Phone App — Jul 2017 – Jul 2018

- Improved spam call detection on Android by adding new call signals into detection models to fight spoofing.
- Increased training data for voicemail transcription models by **30x** by optimizing the user consent flow for sharing voicemails with Google.

PM & Software Engineering Internships — 2014 – 2016

Google (YouTube), Okta, Infosys

- Defined requirements and built a prototype for a tool to manage YouTube Premium promotions. (Google)
- Added profile picture imports/synchronization to Universal Directory and built the supporting storage system on Amazon S3. (Okta)
- Designed and built a UI automation engine using Java, Python, and OpenCV. (Infosys)

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley — May 2017

B.S., highest distinction, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

GPA:	3.95 (Top 3%)
Awards	Arthur M. Hopkin Award; Dean's List (Fa13, Fa14 – Sp16)
Activities	Teaching Assistant, Undergraduate Researcher
Selected Coursework	Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Linear Algebra, Algorithms, Data Structures